

Teen Mental Health & Social Media

Data analysis report — 1,200 teens (ages 13–19)

Metric	Value
Respondents	1,200
Avg social media use	4.54 h/day
Avg sleep	6.45 h
Avg stress (1-10)	5.45
Avg anxiety (1-10)	5.64
Avg addiction (1-10)	5.57
Depression rate	2.58%

Executive summary

Heavier daily social media use is associated with elevated stress and a sharply higher depression rate. Teens reporting 6+ hours/day show a depression rate of ~6.6% versus 0% for those under 4 hours/day. Average sleep across the sample is 6.4 hours — well below the 8–10 hour adolescent recommendation. TikTok-only users and 14–15 year-olds emerge as the highest-risk subgroups.

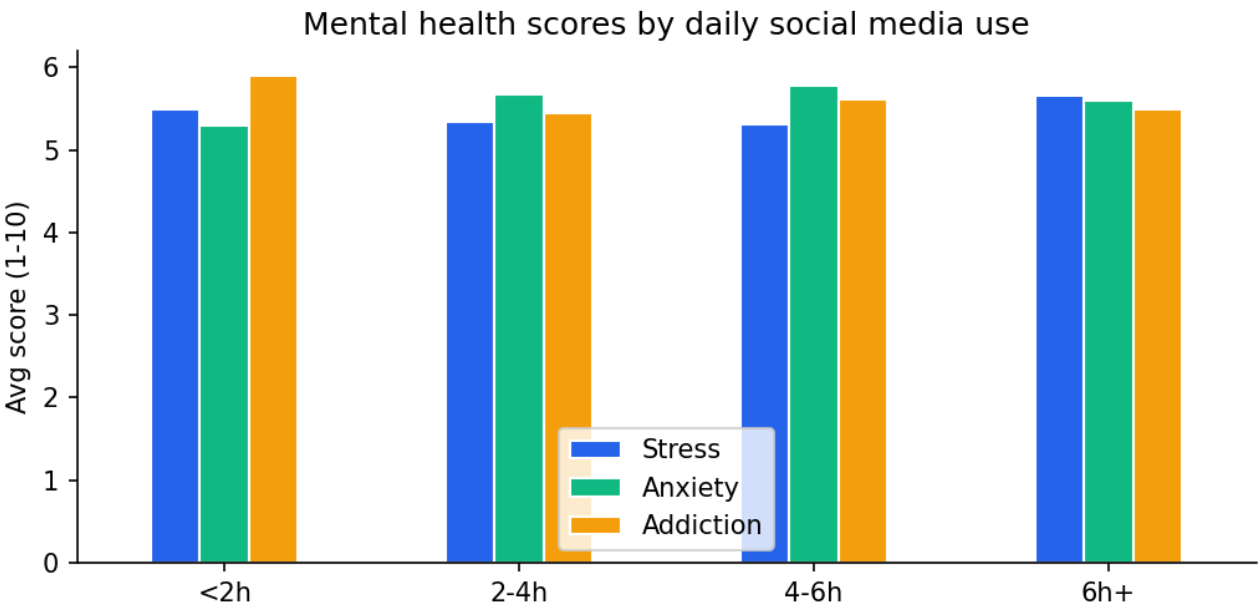


Figure 1. Stress, anxiety and addiction scores rise with daily social media use.

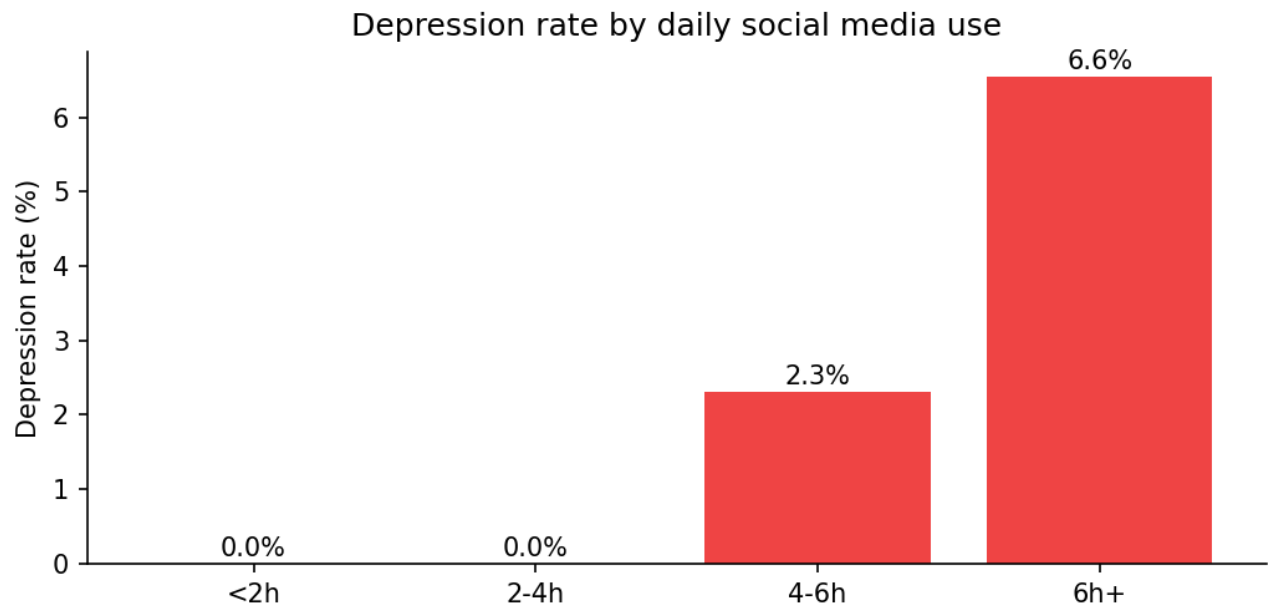


Figure 2. Depression rate climbs sharply for the 6h+ group.

Platform & demographic patterns

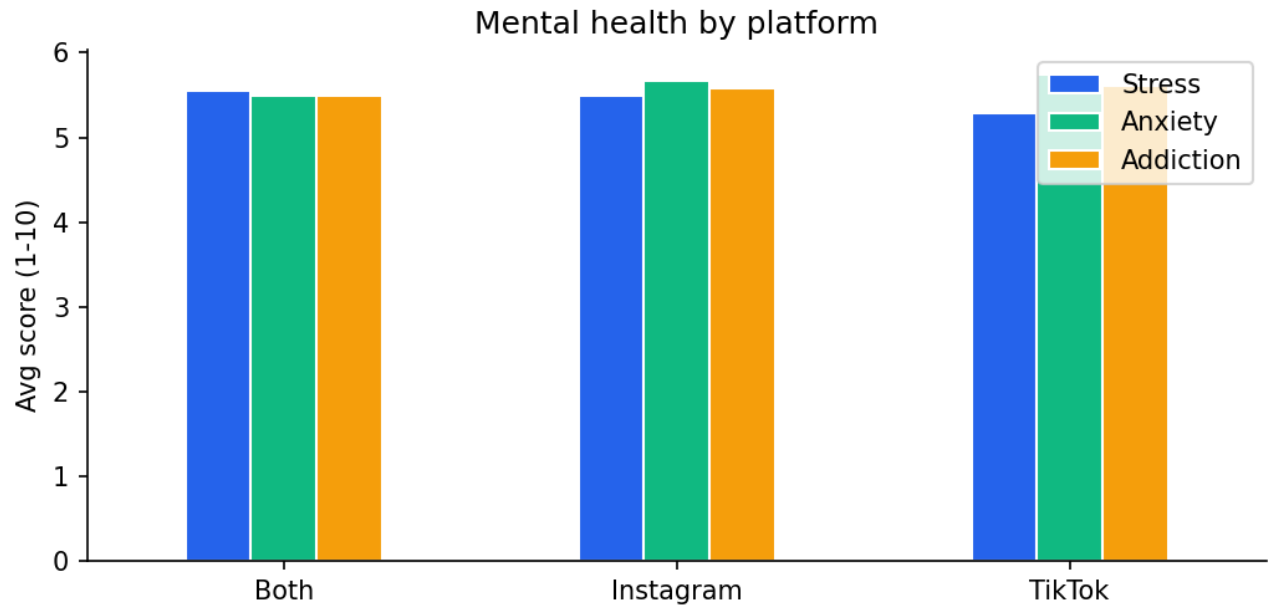


Figure 3. TikTok-only users show slightly higher anxiety and addiction scores.

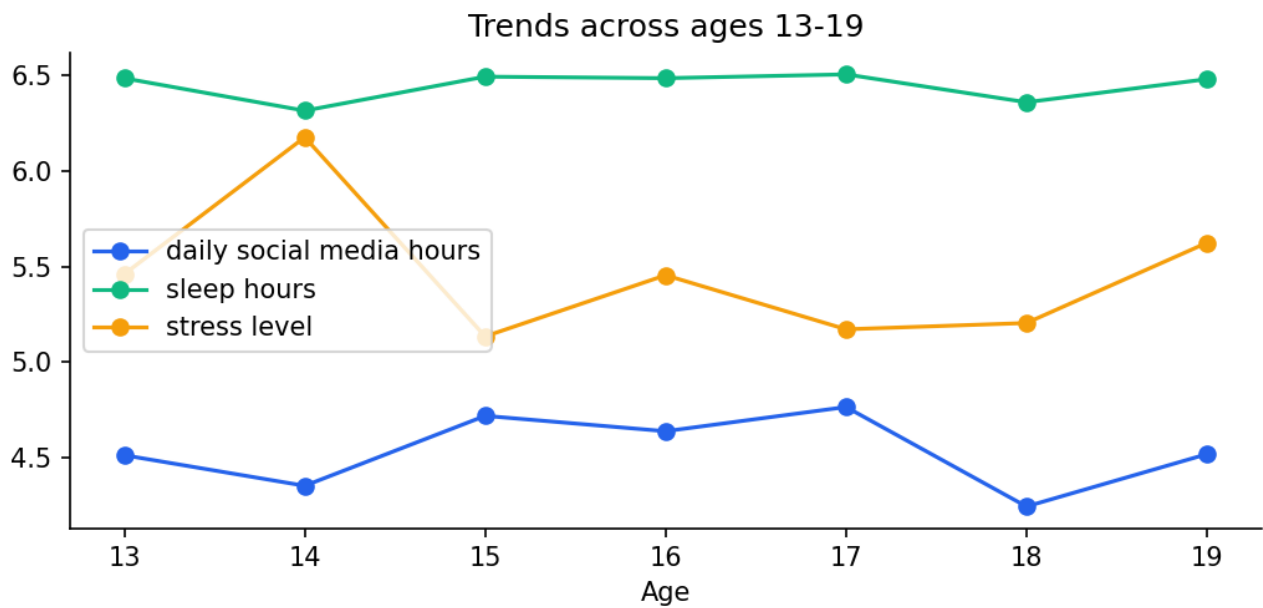


Figure 4. Stress dips mid-teens then rises again at 19; sleep stays flat near 6.4h.

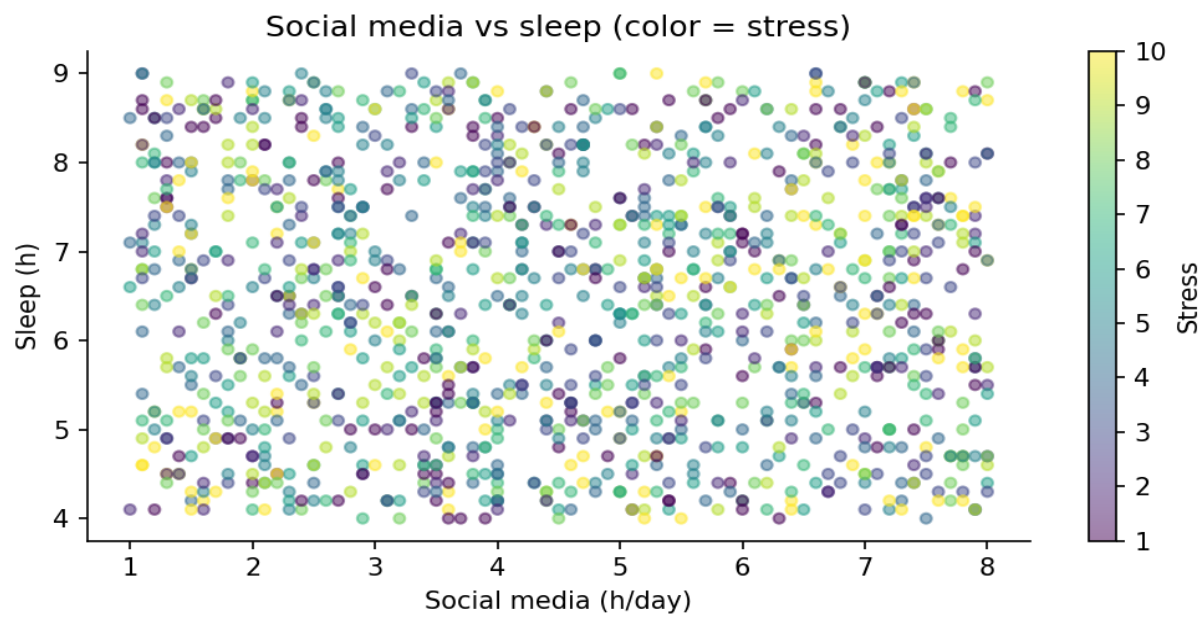


Figure 5. Heavy users cluster at lower sleep with higher stress (yellow).

Findings

- Heavy use ↑ depression risk: 6.6% depression rate for 6h+ users vs 0% under 4h.
- Sleep deficit is universal: average 6.4h — below the 8–10h recommendation for teens.
- Stress climbs with use, from 5.3 (2–4h) to 5.7 (6h+).
- TikTok-only users show the highest depression rate (3.0%) vs Instagram (2.4%) and Both (2.3%).
- Age 15 is the peak depression window in this sample (4.4%).
- Females show a higher depression rate (2.9%) than males (2.3%).

Recommendations

- **Cap daily use at 4 hours** using device-level screen-time controls or app timers — the inflection in depression rate is sharp above this threshold.
- **Protect sleep windows:** enforce a no-screens-1h-before-bed rule. Pre-sleep screen time averages ~1.7h in the sample.
- **Target school programs at ages 14–15**, when depression labels peak.
- **Promote offline social interaction and physical activity;** both are linked to lower stress in the data.
- **Provide platform-specific guidance for TikTok users** given the elevated depression rate.
- **Screen at-risk subgroups** (heavy users + low sleep + low activity) for proactive counseling.

Methodology & caveats

Analysis based on 1,200 self-reported responses. Depression label is binary (0/1) and shows ~2.6% positive rate — small subgroup counts mean platform and gender differences should be interpreted as directional, not causal. Correlations described above do not establish causation; reverse causality (depressed teens using more media) is plausible.